

Demand for the ability to send multimedia messages soon soared, as did the demand for phones that could take pictures with its own little camera. The very first camera phone was Sharp's J-SH04, launched in November 2000.

The Sharp J-SH04—the first camera phone



Cameras, of course, are not enough to satisfy the Modern Customer. The consumer wants a total multimedia experience. And no multimedia experience is complete without music. The growing popularity of the MP3 format meant that in no time, consumers were demanding that their phones should be capable of delivering a satisfactory music experience by being able to play MP3 music on the go. What they didn't know was that there already was an MP3 phone—the Samsung SCH-M210, introduced in 1999. Unfortunately, the MP3 phone concept didn't really take off right then. Today, however, any mobile phone worth its antenna has support for MP3.

The Big Boys—Smartphones

Smartphones took the functions of a cellular phone one step further—they became hybrids of mobile phones and PDAs. In addition to the necessary feature of being able to talk to people, they offered e-mail, fax, calendars to set up appointments, calculators and occasionally even the odd game or two.



The new smartphone from HP